

Amuitz Garmendia Madariaga

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Associate Professor (Profesora Titular de Universidad) Department of Social Sciences, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	2026 – today
Associate Professor (internally tenured) Department of Social Sciences, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	2022 – 2026
Assistant Professor Department of Social Sciences, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	2017 – 2022
Fellow Member Instituto Juan Linz	2017 – today
Max Weber Postdoctoral Fellow Department of Political and Social Sciences, European University Institute	2016 – 2017
Graduate Research and Teaching Assistant Department of Political Science, Binghamton University (SUNY)	2013 – 2016
Fulbright Predoctoral Fellow Department of Political Science, Binghamton University (SUNY)	2011 – 2013

EDUCATION

Ph.D., Political Science Binghamton University Dissertation: <i>Units versus units: disentangling the institutional effects of asymmetric autonomy</i> Committee: Olga Shvetsova (Chair), Mikhail Filippov, William B. Heller, and Pablo Beramendi	2016
M.A., Political Science Binghamton University	2014
M.A., Political Science and Constitutional Law Centro de Estudios Políticos y Constitucionales	2010
B.A., Political Science Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	2009
B.A., Law Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	2008
Complementary Training Empirical Implications of Theoretical Models (EITM), Duke University	2014
ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan, Ann Arbor	2012

ACCREDITATIONS

Profesora Titular de Universidad, ANECA	2025
Profesora Contratada Doctora, ANECA	2024
R3 Certificate, Established Researcher, Agencia Estatal de Investigación	2024
Two research six-year periods (<i>sexenios</i>) recognised	2011–2018, 2019–2024

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Comparative Political Economy · Federal Theory and Decentralization Dynamics ·
Multilevel Politics · Geography and Polarization · Quantitative Analysis and Causal
Inference

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

13. 2026. Crisis and centralisation: how the pandemic reshaped territorial preferences in Spain (with Sandra León). *South European Society and Politics*. Published online 2026: 1–26. (JCR 2025: Political Science 50/332, Q1)
12. 2026. Crisis management and territorial preferences: Experimental evidence during the pandemic (with Sandra León). *European Journal of Political Research*. Published online 2026: 1–23. (JCR 2025: Political Science 32/332, Q1)
11. 2025. The 2023 Spanish general elections and the fourth Sánchez cabinet: A successful gamble for the left? (with Pedro Riera). *Mediterranean Politics* 31(1): 218–231. (JCR 2024: Political Science 135/325, Q2)
10. 2024. Polarización territorial. *Revista de Occidente* 521. (SJR 2024: Cultural Studies 1325/1398, Q4)
9. 2023. The Nationalisation of Subnational Elections in Polarised Spain: the May 2023 Regional and Local Elections (with Pedro Riera). *South European Society and Politics* 28(2): 231–257. (JCR 2023: Political Science 32/318, Q1)
8. 2023. Overlapping polarization: On the contextual determinants of the interplay between ideological and affective polarization (with Pedro Riera). *Electoral Studies* 84: 102628. (JCR 2023: Political Science 50/318, Q1)
7. 2022. Territorial Polarisation after Radical Parties' Breakthrough in Spain (with Pedro Riera). *South European Society and Politics* 27(1): 51–73. (JCR 2022: Political Science 38/187, Q1)
6. 2022. Building Blocks: Online Political Promiscuity in Times of Polarization in Spain (with Javier Lorenzo Rodríguez and Pedro Riera). *Revista Española de Investigaciones Sociológicas* 178: 61–82. (JCR 2022: Sociology 135/217, Q3)
5. 2021. How bad is it? Variation in perceptions of regional economic conditions. *Regional Studies* 55(6): 1140–1153. (JCR 2021: Economics 62/381, Q1)
4. 2018. Passing the buck? Responsibility attribution and cognitive bias in multilevel democracies (with Sandra León and Ignacio Jurado). *West European Politics* 41(3): 660–682. (JCR 2018: Political Science 11/176, Q1)
3. 2016. Going Public Against Institutional Constraints? Analyzing the online presence intensity of 2014 European Parliament election candidates (with Javier Lorenzo Rodríguez). *European Union Politics* 17(2): 303–323. (JCR 2016: Political Science 34/165, Q1)
2. 2015. Looking for Two-Sided Coattail Effects: Integrated Parties and Multilevel Elections in the U.S. (with H. Ege Özen). *Electoral Studies* 40: 66–75. (JCR 2015: Political Science 42/163, Q2)
1. 2011. La disolución de formaciones políticas en España: el caso Sortu [Banning political parties in Spain: the case of Sortu]. *Cuestiones Constitucionales: Revista Mexicana de Derecho Constitucional* 25, July–December. (SJR 2014: Law 548/681, Q4)

BOOK CHAPTERS

7. 2026. Media and Democracy (with Pablo Fernández Vázquez and Pedro Riera). In *Twisted Modernization*, edited by Pablo Beramendi and Carles Boix. Cambridge University Press.
6. 2023. Territorial Polarisation after Radical Parties' Breakthrough in Spain (with Pedro Riera). In *Affective Polarisation in Spain: Electoral, Regional and Media Conflictuality*, edited by Mariano Torcal. Routledge.

5. 2021. The political determinants of decentralization. In *Handbook on Decentralization, Devolution and the State*, edited by Ignacio Lago Peñas. Edward Elgar Publishing.
4. 2021. Fiscal decentralization. In *The Handbook on the Politics of Taxation*, edited by Laura Seelkopf and Lukas Hakelberg. Edward Elgar Publishing.
3. 2019. Passing the buck? Responsibility attribution and cognitive bias in multilevel democracies (with Sandra León and Ignacio Jurado). In *Democratic Representation in Multi-level Systems*, edited by Thomas Däubler, Jochen Müller and Christian Stecker. Routledge.
2. 2013. El sistema político belga. In *Manual de Sistemas Políticos en Europa*. Editorial Tirant Lo Blanch, Madrid (ISBN: 978-84-905-3387-1).
1. 2012. Federalismo judicial: modelo de ordenación del poder judicial en Estados compuestos (with Luis Alberto Trejo Osornio). In *Jurisprudencia del Tribunal Constitucional Español*. Editorial Porrúa, Instituto Mexicano de Derecho Procesal (ISBN: 978-60-709-1070-8).

EDITED BOOKS

5. 2024. Informe sobre la democracia en España 2023: La renuncia al centro (co-edited with Alberto Penadés). Centro de Estudios Políticos y Constitucionales (ISBN: 978-84-18677-16-8).
4. 2023. Informe sobre la democracia en España 2022: El largo plazo (co-edited with Alberto Penadés). Fundación Alternativas and Centro de Estudios Políticos y Constitucionales (ISBN: 978-84-18677-95-3).
3. 2022. The political economy of federalism and multilevel politics in turbulent times (co-edited with Sandra León and Anwen Elias). *Frontiers in Political Science* (doi.org/10.3389/978-2-88976-820-2).
2. 2022. Informe sobre la democracia en España 2021: El país frente al espejo (co-edited with Alberto Penadés). Fundación Alternativas and Centro de Estudios Políticos y Constitucionales (ISBN: 978-84-18677-60-1).
1. 2021. Informe sobre la democracia en España 2020: El año de la pandemia (co-edited with Alberto Penadés). Fundación Alternativas (ISBN: 978-84-18677-18-2).

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

6. 2023. Socialdemocracia, Territorio, e Identidad. In *Retos de la Socialdemocracia*, Revista Grand Place (ISSN: 2386-429X).
5. 2020. ¿El fin del consenso territorial en España? (with Sandra León). In *Informe sobre la democracia en España 2019*, Fundación Alternativas (ISBN: 978-84-122331-5-5).
4. 2020. El poder político territorial. Monográfico Regeneración Democrática, Fundación Felipe González, *Nueva Revista* 173.
3. 2019. 40 años de gobiernos autonómicos en España: competición política, feudos electorales y calidad de gobierno. In *Informe sobre la democracia en España 2018*, Fundación Alternativas (ISBN: 978-84-949660-8-8).
2. 2015. Las estrategias online de los partidos en las elecciones europeas de 2014. ¿Un nicho para los partidos niche? (with Javier Lorenzo). *Estudios de Progreso* 84, Fundación Alternativas (ISBN: 978-84-15860-46-4).
1. 2010. La posible plasmación de la teoría del tercer miembro del Estado federal en el ordenamiento jurídico español. Working Papers CEPC (ISBN: 978-84-259-1506-2).

WORKING PAPERS

- **Territorial Affective Polarization: Concept, Prevalence, and Impact** (with Sandra León)
- **Federalism and Democratic Survival** (with Pablo Beramendi and Sandra León)
- **Borders Within: How Disaster Divides and Unites along Territorial Lines** (with

Sandra León)

- **Disaster in a Distrustful Democracy: Public Reactions to Severe Flooding in Spain** (with Sandra León)
- **Territorial Identity in Comparative Perspective** (with Sandra León and Jair Alva Mendoza)
- **Accountability After Fragmented Conflict: Evidence from South Africa** (with Daniel Urquijo and Paul McLahlan)

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Research Projects

- **Principal Investigator**, 2025–2027: DRIFT “Decentralization, Reforms, Institutions, and the Formation of Territorial Preferences”. Beca Leonardo, Fundación BBVA (€50,000).
- **Co-Principal Investigator** (with Sandra León), 2022–2026: FEDCRISIS (PID2021-128287NB-I00) “Federalism against its challenges: crisis, polarization and populism”. Ministerio de Ciencia e Innovación (€102,850).
- **Team member**, 2021–2025: COST Action OC-2020-1-2479 “Intergovernmental Coordination from Local to European Governance” (PIs: Noemia Bessa and Sean Mueller), Working Group 4.
- **Team member (declined)**, 2021–2024: POLGEO (PID2020-119465GB-C21) “Geography, polarization and the rural-urban divide in the XXI century” (PIs: Pedro Riera and Toni Rodon). Ministerio de Ciencia e Innovación (€60,300).
- **Team member**, 2019: TRI-POL “Las claves de la polarización política y social en las democracias actuales” (PI: Mariano Torcal Lorient). Ayudas a Equipos de Investigación Científica en Economía y Sociedad Digital, Fundación BBVA (€75,000).
- **Team member**, 2017–2020: TIOViVo (RTI2018-098182-A-I00) “Techo Virtual o Ventana de Oportunidad” (PIs: Javier Lorenzo Rodríguez and Margarita Torre). Ministerio de Ciencia e Innovación (€54,450).
- **Team member**, Brújula Electoral, 2015 and 2016 Spanish General Elections (Voting Advice Application by Kieskompas BV and Instituto Carlos III – Juan March de Ciencias Sociales).

Research Contracts

- **2023–2024**. “Study on populist voters”, Friedrich-Ebert-Stiftung (FES), co-PI with Silvia Clavería (€4,405). Report: “Actitudes políticas y sociales de los votantes de Vox”.
- **2021–2022**. “Coexistence and Polarization Survey 2021”, Institut Català Internacional per la Pau (ICIP), co-PI with Sandra León (€3,200). Report: “Polarización y convivencia en España 2021: El papel de lo territorial”.

Awards and Grants

Ambassador of the City of Madrid, Madrid Convention Bureau (for organising EPSA 2025)	2026
Researcher Mobility Grant, Universidad Carlos III de Madrid	2021
Research Grant (€3,000), Institut d’Estudis de l’Autogovern	2021
Conference Travel Grant (\$800, declined), American Political Science Association	2019
Max Weber Fellowship (€24,000, declined), European University Institute	2017–2018
Travel and Expenses Grant (€1,000), Mannheimer Zentrum für Europäische Sozialforschung (MZES)	2015
Dissertation Fellowship, Binghamton University	2015, 2016
“Estudios de Progreso” Award (€1,000, with Javier Lorenzo), Fundación Alternativas	2014
EITM at Duke University, National Science Foundation	2014

Fulbright Foreign Student Program, US-Spain Fulbright Commission / IIE	2011–2016
Best Constitutional Law Master Thesis Award (€1,000), CEPC	2010

CONFERENCES & WORKSHOPS

Invited Talks

Borders Within: How Disaster Divides and Unites along Territorial Lines Research Seminar, Universitat de Barcelona	2025
Borders Within: How Disaster Divides and Unites along Territorial Lines Máster Universitario en Ciencia Política, Universidad de Salamanca	2025
Crises, Coordination Failures, and Centralizing Shifts: Comparative Public Opinion Evidence from the COVID-19 Pandemic MZES AB B-Kolloquium, Universität Mannheim	2023
Territorial Affective Polarization: Concept, Prevalence, and Impact Federalism, Democracy and International Governance Seminar, European University Institute	2023
External Threats, Coordination Failures, and Centralizing Shifts: Comparative Public Opinion Evidence from the COVID-19 Pandemic Political Behavior Colloquium, European University Institute	2021
Fiscal Decentralization and Competitive Politics. Explaining the Survival of Regional Governments Instituto de Políticas y Bienes Públicos, Consejo Superior de Investigaciones Científicas, Spain	2018
Banning political parties in Spain: the case of Sortu Conference: The protection of fundamental rights by the Federal Electoral Court. Electoral Court of the Federal Judicial Branch, Mexico	2013
The possible observance of the Theory of the Third Member of the Federation in the Spanish legal order Workshop: García Pelayo Researchers. Centro de Estudios Políticos y Constitucionales, Spain	2010

Workshop Presentations

From Political to Affective Polarization, Universidad de Barcelona	2022
Twisted Modernization, IPERG, Universidad de Barcelona	2021
The Politics of Taxation, University of Bamberg	2019
Southern Europe in Crisis: A Comparative Perspective, EUI	2017
Political Behavior Colloquium, EUI	2017
When Institutions Fail, EUI	2017

Conference Presentations

American Political Science Association (APSA)	2014, 2015, 2017, 2018
Midwest Political Science Association (MPSA)	2013–2018, 2021
European Political Science Association (EPSA)	2013, 2015–2018, 2021, 2023–2025
Council for European Studies (CES)	2019, 2022
European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR)	2014, 2025
ECPR Joint Sessions: Affective Polarization	2021
Spanish Political Science Association (AECPA)	2019, 2026
Max Weber Programme Annual Conference, EUI	2017, 2018
Southern Political Science Association (SPSA)	2017
Western Empirical Legal Studies Conference, UCLA	2016
Peace Science Online Colloquium	2016
Southern California Comparative Political Institutions Conference, UC Merced	2016
European Election Study Conference, MZES, University of Mannheim	2015

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Graduate Courses, UC3M

Integrative Workshop, Master in Sustainable Development and Global Governance	2023–2025
Advanced Topics in Political Economy, Master in Social Sciences	2022–2025
Globalization and the International Order: Controversies and New Trajectories, Master in Sustainable Development and Global Governance	2022–2025
Talleres de Análisis Político I, Máster en Análisis Político y Electoral	2019–2021

Undergraduate Courses, UC3M

Multidisciplinary Workshop in Globalization, Grado en Estudios Internacionales and double degrees	2017–2025
Teorías y Enfoques en Ciencia Política, Grado en Ciencia Política and double degrees	2017–2019

Undergraduate Courses, Binghamton University

Comparative Constitutions	2016
Multilevel Elections and Parties	2015
Introduction to American Politics	2014
Introduction to Comparative Politics	2013–2014

Methods and Summer Courses

Simulations, Summer School for Women in Political Methodology, University of Zurich	2019
Polarización territorial, “Polarizad@s: La política que nos separa”, UC3M	2024
Polarización política, summer course on the 2024 European Parliament elections, UNED Madrid	2024
Filias y fobias territoriales, “El impacto de las elecciones autonómicas y locales en las elecciones generales. ¿Cambio de ciclo?”, UNED Denia	2023

Student Supervision

Álvaro San Román (PhD, tutor)	2025 – today
<i>Multi-tier redistributive interests at the core of European integration preferences.</i> UC3M	
Jair Alva Mendoza (PhD, advisor)	2023 – today
<i>The Political Effects of Crises in the Territorial Organization of Political Systems.</i> UC3M	
Master’s theses supervised: 5 · Bachelor’s theses: 84 hours of supervision	2017 – today

Examination Committees

PhD committee: Berta Caihuelas Navajas, Universidad de Valladolid	2025
PhD committee: Sergio Velasco Monje, Universidad de Valladolid	2024
PhD committee: Paula Zuluaga, European University Institute	2021
Master’s thesis committees: 12 · Bachelor’s thesis committees: 94	2017 – today

SERVICE

Editorial

Methods Editor, <i>Regional & Federal Studies</i>	2026 – today
Reviewer for <i>Acta Politica</i> , <i>Comparative Political Studies</i> , <i>Electoral Studies</i> , <i>European Journal of Political Research</i> , <i>European Political Science Review</i> , <i>European Union Politics</i> , <i>Governance</i> , <i>Government and Opposition</i> , <i>Journal of Politics</i> , <i>Political Behavior</i> , <i>Publius</i> , <i>Regional & Federal Studies</i> and <i>South European Society and Politics</i> , among others.	

Evaluation and Expert Roles

External evaluator for the Agencia Estatal de Investigación, Agencia Andaluza del Conocimiento, Fulbright Commission and Institut d’Estudis de l’Autogovern	
Advisory Council, Informe sobre la Democracia en España, Fundación Alternativas	2018 – today

Co-Director, Informe sobre la Democracia en España, Fundación Alternativas (2020–2023 editions)	2021 – 2024
Chapel Hill Expert Survey (Spanish political parties)	2017 – today

Institutional

Acting Director, Instituto Juan Linz (led its creation from the IC3JM, completed December 2025)	2025
Academic Secretary, Instituto Carlos III – Juan March (IC3JM)	2021 – 2025
Convenor of the Permanent Seminar Series, IC3JM	2020 – 2025
Vice Chair of Political Science, Department of Social Sciences, UC3M	2019 – 2021
Elected member of the University Senate (Claustro), UC3M	2018 – 2020
Mentor, junior faculty mentoring programme, Department of Social Sciences, UC3M	2022 – today
Volunteer tutor, Programa Ecuador, UC3M	2018 – 2019
Researcher Mentorship Programme, European University Institute	2016 – 2017
Treasurer, Political Science Graduate Student Organization, Binghamton University	2012 – 2013

Professional Community

Co-organisier, European Political Science Association Annual Conference, UC3M, Madrid	2025
Founding member, Madrid Empirical Social Sciences (MESS)	2024 – today
Member, research group “Political Economy of Institutions and Conflict” (EPIC), UC3M	2021 – today
Memberships: AECPA · APSA · EPSA · MPSA · CES	

PUBLIC ENGAGEMENT

Media

Interview on polarization in Spain, Noticias Cuatro	2024
“¿Por qué catalanes y madrileños caemos tan mal?”, PAUSA podcast with Marta García Aller, ep. 51	2023
Presentation of the Informe sobre la Democracia en España, El Parlamento, RTVE La 2	2023
Documentary “Zentzura mozioaren giltzak”, EiTb1	2019

Policy Reports

RESILIO (Resilience of European Integration) Country Report: Spain, Institut für Europäische Politik	2023
Polarización y convivencia en España 2021: El papel de lo territorial, ICIP	2021

NON-ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Legal Scholar	2010 – 2011
Doctrine Service, Constitutional Court of Spain	
MP Assistant	2009 – 2010
Committee of Home Affairs, House of Representatives, Spain	
Law Degree Practicum	Spring 2008
Supreme Court of Spain	

Last updated: September 27, 2026